# Module 1: Introduction to AI and Data Science

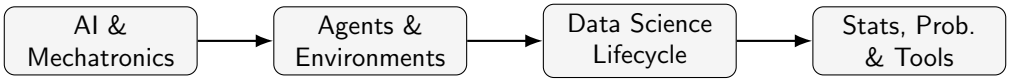
## Fundamentals, Intelligent Agents, and Data Lifecycles

Dr. Rajan Prasad

SMEC
VIT University

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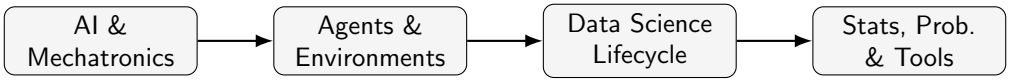
# Learning Story for This Module




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Understand how intelligent systems perceive, decide, and act, and how data serves as the foundation for learning.

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We begin by defining AI in the context of physical and mechanical systems.

**What is AI?**

- Creating systems capable of performing tasks that typically require human intelligence.
- Encompasses reasoning, learning, perception, and problem-solving.

**Core Paradigms:**

- **Symbolic AI:** Logic and rules (Expert Systems).
- **Machine Learning:** Data-driven statistical models.
- **Deep Learning:** Artificial Neural Networks.

## The AI Definition Matrix

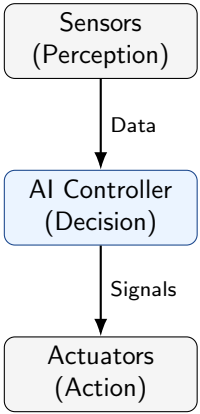
| **Thinking Humanly** | **Thinking Rationally** |
|---|---|
| Cognitive modeling | Laws of thought |
| **Acting Humanly** | **Acting Rationally** |
| Turing test approach | Rational agents |



***Artificial Intelligence is the science and engineering of making intelligent machines, especially intelligent computer programs.***

- John McCarthy, father of AI

# AI's Role in Mechatronics



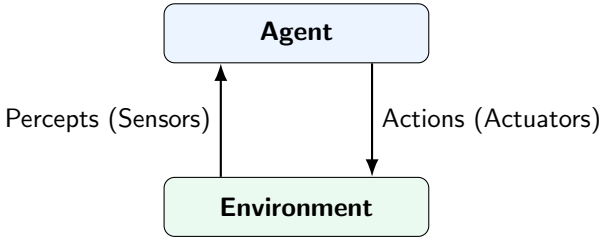

**Mechatronic Synergy**

AI acts as the "brain" linking mechanical and electronic systems.

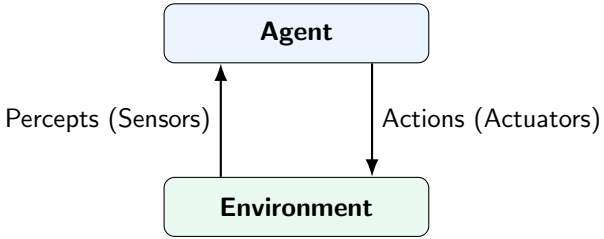
- **Predictive Maintenance:** Identifying wear before failure.
- **Adaptive Control:** Adjusting PID parameters in real-time.
- **Computer Vision:** Quality inspection in manufacturing.

# Intelligent Systems: Agents

An **agent** is anything that can perceive its environment through sensors and act upon that environment through actuators.



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$$f : \mathcal{P}^* \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$$

An agent function $f$ maps a sequence of percepts $\mathcal{P}^*$ to an action $\mathcal{A}$.

# Types of Agents

**Agent Definitions**

- **Simple Reflex Agents:** Act only on the current percept. Ignore history.
- **Model-Based Agents:** Maintain an internal state to track the unseen world.
- **Goal-Based Agents:** Act to achieve specific target states or destinations.
- **Utility-Based Agents:** Maximize a defined "happiness" or efficiency metric.
- **Learning Agents:** Improve their performance metric over time through experience.

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## Mechatronics Examples

- **Reflex:** A basic line-following robot (steers based only on current sensor reading).
- **Model-Based:** A robotic vacuum keeping an internal map of areas it has already cleaned.
- **Goal-Based:** An autonomous drone calculating a path to reach a specific GPS coordinate.
- **Utility-Based:** A self-driving car choosing a route that perfectly balances speed, safety, and fuel efficiency.
- **Learning:** A bipedal robot figuring out how to walk on uneven terrain through trial and error.

# Properties of Environments

The complexity of an AI system is dictated by its environment.

| Property | Description |
|---|---|
| **Fully vs. Partially Observable** | Can the agent's sensors see the entire state at all times? |
| **Deterministic vs. Stochastic** | Does the current state and action uniquely determine the next state? |
| **Episodic vs. Sequential** | Does the current action affect future decisions? |
| **Static vs. Dynamic** | Does the environment change while the agent is deliberating? |
| **Discrete vs. Continuous** | Are there a finite number of states/actions? |

**Real-world mechatronic environments are mostly Partially Observable, Stochastic, Sequential, Dynamic, and Continuous.**

**What is Data Science?**
An interdisciplinary field that uses scientific methods, processes, algorithms, and systems to extract knowledge and insights from data.

**Key Pillars:**

1. Domain Expertise
2. Mathematics & Statistics
3. Computer Science (Hacking Skills)

**Relationship to AI**

AI provides the modeling algorithms (Machine/Deep Learning). Data Science provides the pipeline (data collection, cleaning, and evaluation) to make those models useful.

# Types of Data

## Structured Data

Highly organized, clearly defined data types.

- Relational databases
- Spreadsheets (CSV, Excel)
- Sensor arrays $(x, y, z)$

## Unstructured Data

No predefined data model or organization.

- Images & Video
- Audio signals
- Text documents

## Semi-Structured Data

Does not conform to rigid tables but contains tags.

- JSON files
- XML logs
- HTML

Modern AI models (like Neural Networks) excel at extracting features directly from Unstructured data.

# Data Preprocessing: Why is it needed?

Real-world data is often incomplete, inconsistent, and lacking in certain behaviors.

- **Missing Data:** Sensors fail, packets drop. (Needs Imputation).
- **Noisy Data:** Electronic interference causes random errors. (Needs Filtering/Smoothing).
- **Outliers:** Mechanical shocks create extreme spikes. (Needs Clipping/Removal).
- **Inconsistent Scales:** Temperature is $0 - 100°C$, but pressure is $0 - 10,000$ Pa.

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Garbage In $\rightarrow$ Garbage Out. Algorithms cannot learn patterns from pure noise.

# Data Preprocessing: Scaling & Encoding

**Feature Scaling** Neural networks and distance-based algorithms require data on a similar scale.

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*Min-Max Normalization (0 to 1):*

$$X_{norm} = \frac{X - X_{min}}{X_{max} - X_{min}}$$

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$$Z = \frac{X - \mu}{\sigma}$$

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**Categorical Encoding** Machines only understand numbers.

- **Label Encoding:** Red $= 0$, Green $= 1$, Blue $= 2$.
- **One-Hot Encoding:** Red $= [1, 0, 0]$, Green $= [0, 1, 0]$, Blue $= [0, 0, 1]$.

# Data Visualization Fundamentals

Visualization translates complex numeric data into visual geometry.

| Plot Type | Best Used For... |
|---|---|
| **Line Chart** | Time-series data (e.g., motor RPM over 10 seconds). |
| **Scatter Plot** | Finding correlations between two variables ($X_1$ vs $X_2$). |
| **Histogram** | Understanding the distribution of a single variable. |
| **Box Plot** | Identifying outliers and visualizing statistical quartiles. |
| **Heatmap** | Displaying correlation matrices for multiple variables. |

## Insight

Sometimes, Datasets with identical statistical properties can have drastically different distributions. Always visualize your data.

# Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)

EDA is the detective work performed before building AI models.

**Primary Goals of EDA:**

- Discover underlying patterns and structures.
- Extract important features (Feature Selection).
- Detect anomalies or outliers.
- Test underlying statistical assumptions.

**Tools for EDA**

Python libraries like `Pandas` for manipulation, and `Matplotlib`/`Seaborn` for charting.

**EDA prevents us from blindly applying algorithms to unsuitable data.**

# Use of AI Tools and Platforms: Software

**Standard Languages:** Python, R, C++ (for edge deployment).

| Library/Tool | Primary Use Case |
|---|---|
| **Pandas / NumPy** | Data manipulation, matrices, array operations. |
| **Scikit-Learn** | Traditional ML (SVMs, Decision Trees, PCA). |
| **TensorFlow / Keras** | Building and deploying deep neural networks (Google). |
| **PyTorch** | Research and dynamic neural networks (Meta). |
| **OpenCV** | Computer vision and image processing. |

**For mechatronics, Python is used for training, while C++ is used for real-time deployment on microcontrollers.**

# Platforms for AI in Mechatronics

**Cloud AI Platforms**

- AWS SageMaker, Google Cloud AI, Azure ML.
- *Pros:* Infinite compute power, easy storage.
- *Cons:* Latency issues. Unsuitable for real-time robotic control.

**Edge AI Hardware (Mechatronics focus)**

- NVIDIA Jetson Nano / Orin.
- Google Coral TPU.
- Microcontrollers (TinyML on Arduino/STM32).
- *Pros:* Zero latency, offline capability.

**TinyML**

The intersection of machine learning and embedded systems, allowing AI models to run on milliwatt-power microcontrollers.

# Module Summary

- **AI in Mechatronics:** Bridges sensors and actuators through intelligent decision-making.
- **Agents:** Systems map percepts to actions. Environment dictates complexity.
- **Data Lifecycle:** A continuous loop from collection, cleaning, and EDA to modeling.
- **Data Prep & EDA:** Critical steps ensuring quality data feeds the models.
- **Math Foundations:** Statistics measures data dispersion; Probability handles uncertainty.
- **Tools:** Ecosystem ranges from Cloud frameworks to Edge devices (TinyML).

Data is the fuel. Math is the engine. AI is the vehicle.